hypothesize that the shortest the distance, the fastest we can travel it.

But even this simplified scenario can be made yet simpler: figure 14.8, for instance, shows a portion of a city where roads form a regular grid; this is a common situation in many cities in the United States, while elsewhere in the world it’s not necessarily as common – in Europe, for instance, many city centers have a plant originally designed during the Middle Age or even earlier, and roads are far less regular.

Anyway, for the moment we can imagine to restrict to this ideal situation; why is that? Well, because it makes our job easier: if all blocks are the same, and can be approximated with squares (or rectangles whose sides’ proportions are close to squares’), then we don’t have to worry about real distances, we can just count the number of blocks traveled to compute the length of a route; and the problem would be trivial to solve… if it wasn’t for one-way roads! Once we have a minimum viable solution working for this simplified scenario, we can think about developing it to cover more life-like situations.